Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names
Master Functional Skills	Model Solutions (MFS)

Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills

Centre Number	Candidate Number
MFS-UK	PENR2/P4

Past Paper 4

Time: 75 minutes | Paper Reference **PENR2/S04**

English

Component 2: Reading
Level 2

Use the Text Booklet provided.
You may use a dictionary.

Total Marks: 35 /35

My signature confirms that I will not discuss the content of the exam with anyone.

Signature: Master Functional Skills (MFS)

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- Sign the declaration.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided
  – *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this paper is **35** marks.
- There is a total of 15 questions:
  – Questions 1 to 4 are based on Text A
  – Questions 5 to 8 are based on Text B
  – Questions 9 to 11 are based on Text C
  – Questions 12 to 15 are based on more than one text.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets
- This paper assesses your reading skills, not your writing skills.
- You do not need to write in sentences.

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

Turn over ▶

P67317A

©2020 Pearson Education Ltd.

1/1/1

P 6 7 3 1 7 A 0 1 1 2

Pearson

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

ONLINE LEARNING PLATFORM & ACCREDITED COURSES

Pearson Edexcel & Open Awards Accredited Suite · Entry 3, Level 1 & Level 2

Pass Your Functional Skills Exams With Confidence

100% Pass Guarantee | Dyslexia-Friendly Learning | 1-to-1 Expert Tutor Support

Master Functional Skills provides an adaptive, dyslexia-friendly online learning platform tailored for adult learners, apprentices, and healthcare & vocational staff. Everything you need to revise, practice, and pass is at your fingertips.

1. Smart Diagnostic Initial Assessment

Calculate your exact working level and pinpoint knowledge gaps instantly

- **Exact Grade Calculation:** Adaptive assessments calculate your exact level across all topics.
- **Personalised Study Pathway:** Skip what you know; focus 100% on the topics needed to pass.
- **Real-Time Exam Readiness:** Predictive tracker confirms when you are 100% ready to book.

2. Comprehensive Video Lessons & Worked Solutions

Bite-sized visual explainers covering every single Maths & English curriculum standard

- **Step-by-Step Video Lessons:** Master percentages, algebra, perimeter, ratio, and reverse fractions.
- **Multi-Ink Handwriting Models:** Visual 3-colour methods showing working, carries, and examiner tips.
- **Tutor Shortcuts & Golden Rules:** Proven non-calculator mental arithmetic hacks and BIDMAS tricks.

3. Full Mock Exams & Real-Time Performance Analytics

Practice in exam conditions and watch your scores and confidence climb

- **Authentic Exam Papers:** Timed Section A & Section B papers formatted exactly like Pearson Edexcel.
- **Instant Topic Breakdown:** View percentage scores across Number, Measure/Shape, and Data.
- **Historical Score Tracking:** Monitor past attempts to ensure continuous improvement before exam day.

Ready to Master Your Functional Skills & Pass First Time?

Join thousands of healthcare staff, apprentices, and adult learners across the UK.

Instant 24/7 access on desktop, tablet, and mobile with no software to install.

START LEARNING TODAY AT

MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk

Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills – Level 2

Past Paper 4

Time: 75 minutes | Paper Reference **PENR2/S04**

English

Component 2: Reading
Text Booklet

Do not return this Text Booklet with the Question and Answer Booklet.

Instructions

- You should write your answers in the Question and Answer Booklet.
- You must **not** write any responses to questions in this Text Booklet.

Information

- This Text Booklet contains the three texts required for the Level 2 Component 2: Reading exam.
- This Text Booklet must be securely destroyed by the centre immediately after the exam has been completed.

Advice

- Read each text before you answer the questions.

HOW TO USE THIS MFS ANNOTATED SOURCE TEXT BOOKLET

This Source Booklet contains the three official reading texts (Text A, Text B, and Text C) fully annotated by MFS examiners to show you exactly where and how to find every answer:

· Text A (Page 2 · Webpage): Mapped to Questions 1, 2, 3, 4, 12(a), 13, 14, and 15.

· Text B (Page 3 · Newspaper Article): Mapped to Questions 5, 6, 7(a), 7(b), 8(a), 8(b), 14, and 15.

· Text C (Page 4 · Blog): Mapped to Questions 9, 10, 11, 12(b), 13, and 15.

Turn over ▶

P67317A
©2020 Pearson Education Ltd.
1/1/1

P 6 7 3 1 7 A

Pearson

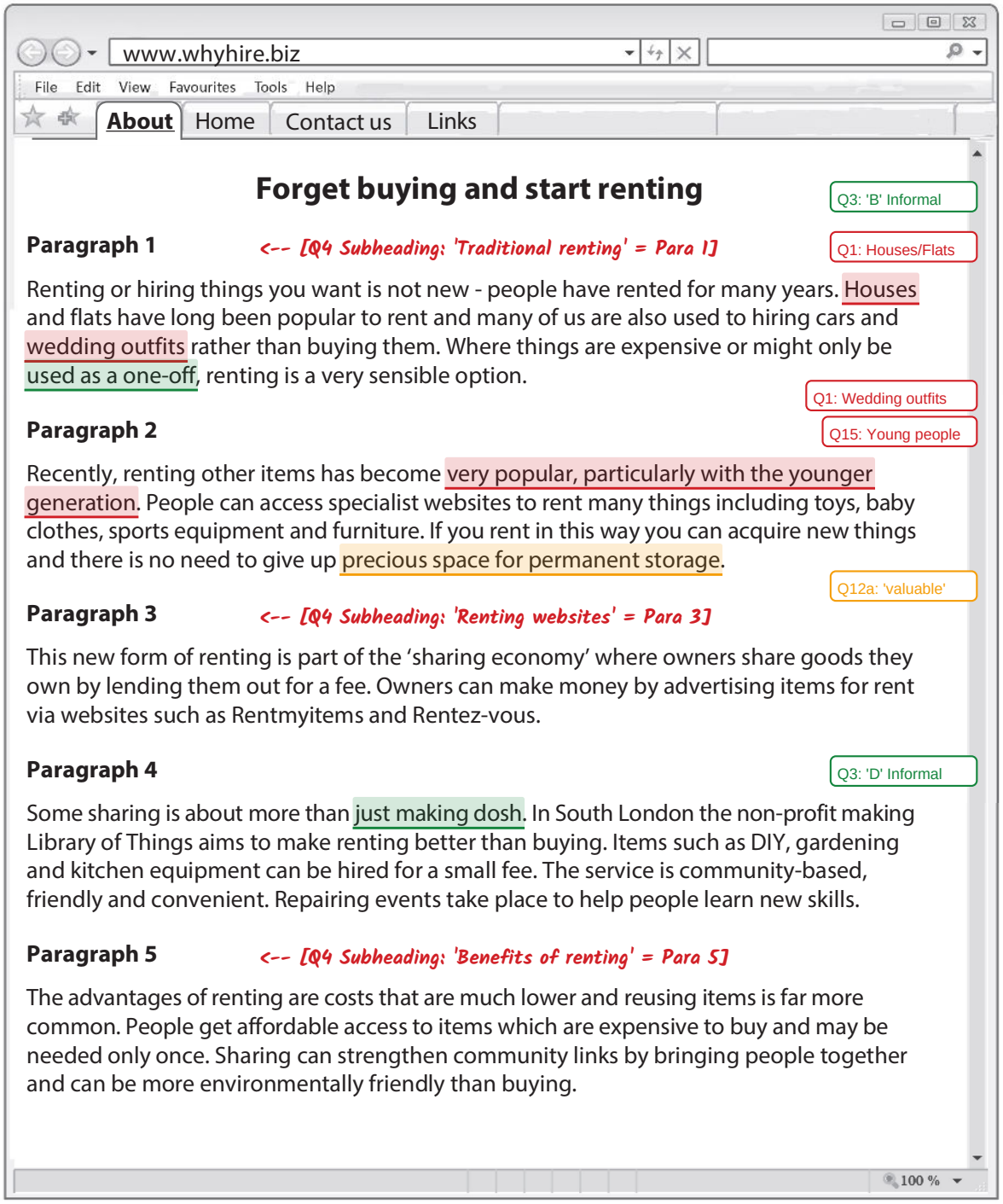
Text A

Webpage

MFS ACTIVE READING GUIDE · TEXT A (WEBPAGE: QUESTIONS 1·4, 12a, 13, 14, 15)

· Style (Q2): Enthusiastic webpage (Option D) promoting renting over buying ('Library of Things').

· Key: Crimson = Q1 Traditional & Q15 | Green = Q3 Informal ('B','D') | Gold = Q12a | Navy = Q13



Forget buying and start renting

Q3: 'B' Informal

Paragraph 1 *<-- [Q4 Subheading: 'Traditional renting' = Para 1]*

Q1: Houses/Flats

Renting or hiring things you want is not new - people have rented for many years. Houses and flats have long been popular to rent and many of us are also used to hiring cars and wedding outfits rather than buying them. Where things are expensive or might only be used as a one-off, renting is a very sensible option.

Q1: Wedding outfits

Paragraph 2

Q15: Young people

Recently, renting other items has become very popular, particularly with the younger generation. People can access specialist websites to rent many things including toys, baby clothes, sports equipment and furniture. If you rent in this way you can acquire new things and there is no need to give up precious space for permanent storage.

Q12a: 'valuable'

Paragraph 3 *<-- [Q4 Subheading: 'Renting websites' = Para 3]*

This new form of renting is part of the 'sharing economy' where owners share goods they own by lending them out for a fee. Owners can make money by advertising items for rent via websites such as Rentmyitems and Rentez-vous.

Paragraph 4

Q3: 'D' Informal

Some sharing is about more than just making dosh. In South London the non-profit making Library of Things aims to make renting better than buying. Items such as DIY, gardening and kitchen equipment can be hired for a small fee. The service is community-based, friendly and convenient. Repairing events take place to help people learn new skills.

Paragraph 5 *<-- [Q4 Subheading: 'Benefits of renting' = Para 5]*

The advantages of renting are costs that are much lower and reusing items is far more common. People get affordable access to items which are expensive to buy and may be needed only once. Sharing can strengthen community links by bringing people together and can be more environmentally friendly than buying.

Text B

Newspaper article

MFS ACTIVE READING GUIDE · TEXT B (ARTICLE: QUESTIONS 5·8, 14, 15)

· Purpose: Newspaper article by Hannah Parry examining the rise of the sharing economy (75% bullet).

· Key: Gold = Q5 Quotes & Q14 Rule of 3 | Green = Q6 ('A') | Crimson = Q7 (75% Bullets) & Q8a/b

Sharing economy

by Hannah Parry

- People are now choosing to hire or rent rather than own goods.
- Everything from clothes and handbags to music is rented.
- Younger people are less materialistic than older people with 75% preferring experiences to things.

Q7a/b: 75% Bullets

Q15: 20-somethings

Many people are choosing to rent rather than buy. Teenagers and twenty-somethings are boosting the sharing economy and almost anything is available to rent. According to a report, those born after 2000 are much less materialistic than older people. Many young people think that having access to items is much more important than owning them. The sharing economy does not only benefit those who rent. Owners can make cash from their unused stuff.

In most sharing services, the lender posts their goods online and decides how much to charge for their items. Many people rent from clothes-borrowing sites such as Rentez-vous, Girl Meets Dress and My Dressing which are becoming more and more popular. They help owners to make cash from their cast-off clothes. The fashion conscious are helped to dress for that one-off special occasion and dodge a hefty price tag. Top-notch jewellery can be rented from Diamond Thrills and high-end, must-have designer handbags from The Handbag Rental.

The sharing economy also benefits dog owners. BorrowMyDoggy.com links dog lovers to dog owners so that their dogs can enjoy more regular walks. DogVacay helps owners find their dog a loving home rather than kennels when they go on holiday, which can save them money. Film and music have also seen a massive move away from ownership thanks to streaming sites such as Netflix, Amazon Prime and Spotify. Some people even think that there is no need to own any films or music.

The report found the sharing economy is growing fast. This super-quick growth is helped by rapidly changing attitudes to the ownership of goods. Around 80% of people think that there are many advantages in renting over owning. Two thirds of people who rent wish to live a less materialistic and a more environmentally friendly lifestyle.

Adapted from article by Hannah Parry mailonline.com

Q5: Stylish trends

Q5: Eco-friendly

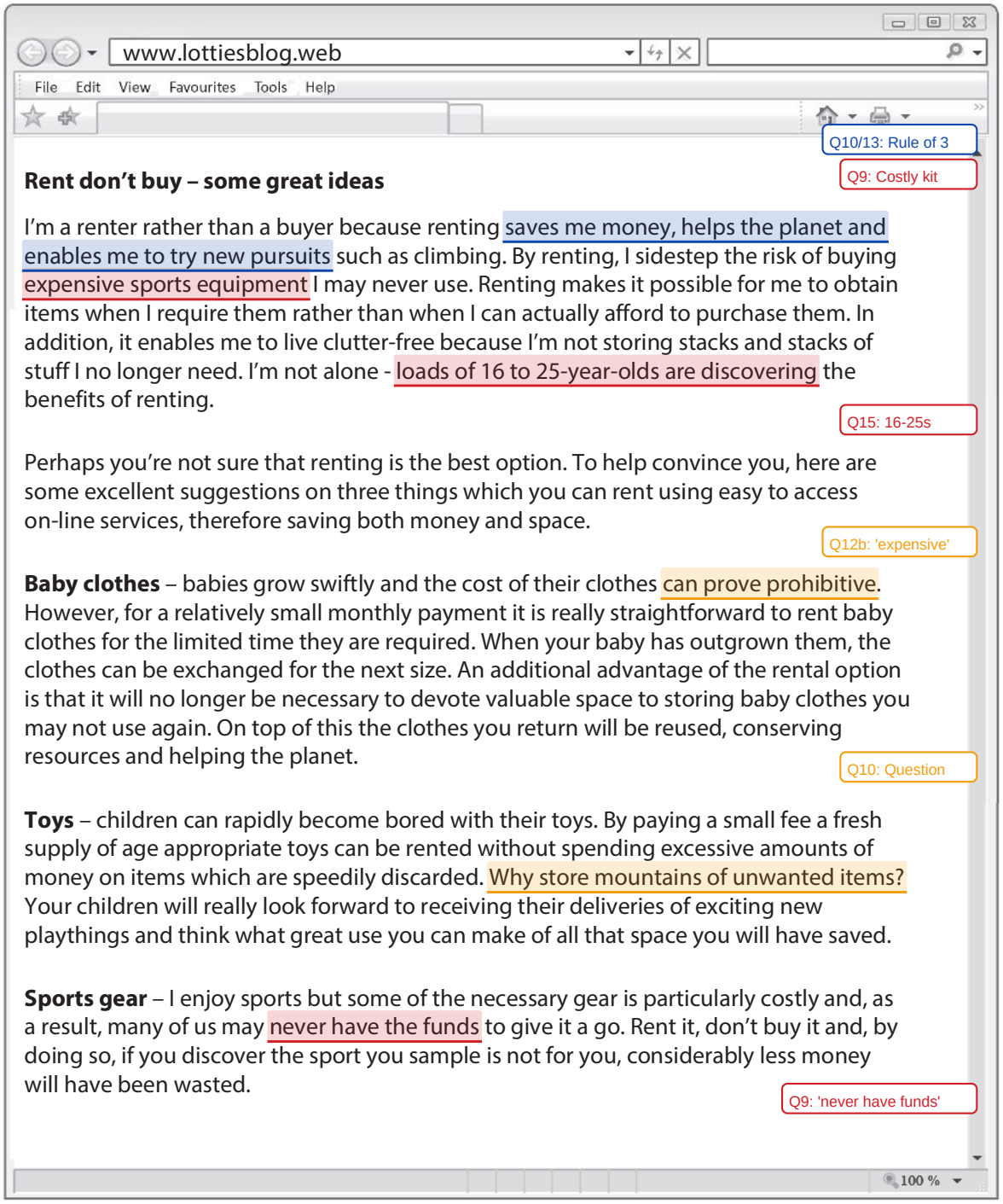
Text C

Blog

MFS ACTIVE READING GUIDE · TEXT C (BLOG: QUESTIONS 9·11, 12b, 13, 15)

· Purpose: Lottie's blog advising readers on renting sports equipment, musical instruments & art.

· Key: Crimson = Q9 Cost Quotes & Q11 | Gold = Q10 Features & Q12b ('prohibitive') | Navy = Q13



Rent don't buy – some great ideas

I'm a renter rather than a buyer because renting saves me money, helps the planet and enables me to try new pursuits such as climbing. By renting, I sidestep the risk of buying expensive sports equipment I may never use. Renting makes it possible for me to obtain items when I require them rather than when I can actually afford to purchase them. In addition, it enables me to live clutter-free because I'm not storing stacks and stacks of stuff I no longer need. I'm not alone - loads of 16 to 25-year-olds are discovering the benefits of renting.

Perhaps you're not sure that renting is the best option. To help convince you, here are some excellent suggestions on three things which you can rent using easy to access on-line services, therefore saving both money and space.

Baby clothes – babies grow swiftly and the cost of their clothes can prove prohibitive. However, for a relatively small monthly payment it is really straightforward to rent baby clothes for the limited time they are required. When your baby has outgrown them, the clothes can be exchanged for the next size. An additional advantage of the rental option is that it will no longer be necessary to devote valuable space to storing baby clothes you may not use again. On top of this the clothes you return will be reused, conserving resources and helping the planet.

Toys – children can rapidly become bored with their toys. By paying a small fee a fresh supply of age appropriate toys can be rented without spending excessive amounts of money on items which are speedily discarded. Why store mountains of unwanted items? Your children will really look forward to receiving their deliveries of exciting new playthings and think what great use you can make of all that space you will have saved.

Sports gear – I enjoy sports but some of the necessary gear is particularly costly and, as a result, many of us may never have the funds to give it a go. Rent it, don't buy it and, by doing so, if you discover the sport you sample is not for you, considerably less money will have been wasted.

Answer ALL questions. Write your answers in the spaces provided.

SECTION A

Read Text A and answer Questions 1 to 4.

1 Your friend wants to know what people have been renting for many years.

Using Text A, identify **two** things people have been renting for many years.

1 Houses and flats.

<-- Text A Para 1: rented for many years [1 mark] (1)

2 Cars and wedding outfits.

<-- Text A Para 1: cars & formal wear [1 mark] (1)

(Total for Question 1 = 2 marks)

Answer Question 2 with a cross in a box ☒. If you change your mind about an answer, put a line through the box ☒ and then mark your new answer with a cross ☒.

2 Which word best describes the style of Text A?

- ☐ **A** humorous
- ☐ **B** impartial
- ☐ **C** irritated
- ☒ **D** enthusiastic [1 mark]

^ Correct: Option D: 'enthusiastic' (official mark...

(Total for Question 2 = 1 mark)

MFS EXAMINER STRATEGY · SECTION A RETRIEVAL & STYLE (QUESTIONS 1 & 2)

· Question 1 (2 Marks): Scan Text A for two distinct facts answering the prompt (1 mark per point).

· Question 2 (1 Mark): Identify the writer's overall purpose and tone across the whole of Text A.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

Answer Question 3 with a cross in two boxes ☒. If you change your mind about an answer, put a line through the box ☒ and then mark your new answer with a cross ☒.

3 Which **two** of these quotations from Text A are examples of informal language?

- ☐ **A** 'been popular to rent'
- ☒ **B** 'used as a one-off' *[1 mark]*
- ☐ **C** 'a very sensible option'
- ☒ **D** 'just making dosh' *[1 mark]*
- ☐ **E** 'costs that are much lower'

^ Correct: Options B & D ('used as a one-off' & '...

(Total for Question 3 = 2 marks)

4 You have been asked to add subheadings to each paragraph in Text A.

Number each subheading from 1 to 5 to show which best matches each paragraph.

Two have been done for you.

Subheading	Paragraph number
Benefits of renting	5 <-- Para 5
Traditional renting	1 <-- Para 1
The Library of Things	4
Renting websites	3 <-- Para 3 [2 marks]
The growth of renting	2

(Total for Question 4 = 2 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION A = 7 MARKS

SECTION A SUMMARY · TEXT A (QUESTIONS 1 TO 4) 7 / 7 MARKS

· Question 3 (2 Marks): Check whether the question asks for FORMAL or INFORMAL language before selecting.

· Question 4 (2 Marks): Read the opening sentence of each paragraph in Text A to match all 3 remaining numbers.

· Marking Rule: All 3 missing paragraph numbers correct = 2 marks; 1 correct = 1 mark.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

SECTION B

Read Text B and answer Questions 5 to 8.

5 What does each of these quotations from Text B suggest about the writer's attitude to young people?

'fashion conscious' People who are interested in fashion, follow the latest trends and want to look stylish. <-- 'fashion conscious' [1 mark] (1)

'environmentally friendly lifestyle' Living in a greener way that protects the planet and avoids damaging the environment. [1 mark] (1)

(Total for Question 5 = 2 marks)

Answer Question 6 with a cross in a box ☒. If you change your mind about an answer, put a line through the box ☒ and then mark your new answer with a cross ☒.

6 Text B includes both facts and opinions.

Which **one** of these statements is an opinion?

- ☒ **A** Owning films and music is unnecessary. [1 mark]
- ☐ **B** The sharing economy is growing quickly.
- ☐ **C** Owners can make money from renting.
- ☐ **D** Items can be rented using websites.

^ Correct: Option A: 'Owning films and music is unn...

(Total for Question 6 = 1 mark)

7 (a) According to the writer of Text B, what percentage of younger people prefer experiences to things?

75% (75 per cent) <-- Exact detail from Text B [1 mark] (1)

(b) Which organisational feature in Text B shows this?

Bullet points <-- Organisational feature in Text B [1 mark] (1)

(Total for Question 7 = 2 marks)

MFS EXAMINER STRATEGY · IMPLICIT MEANING & FACT VS OPINION (QUESTIONS 5-7)

- Question 5 (2 Marks): Explain what each quotation suggests in your own words rather than repeating the quote.
- Question 6 (1 Mark): An OPINION contains a value judgement ('best', 'always', 'should') that cannot be proven.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

8 (a) Using Text B, identify **two** reasons why people like to rent clothes and accessories.

1 To dress up for a special occasion and avoid a hefty price tag (it is much cheaper). <-- Text B [1 mark] **(1)**

2 To gain access to top-notch jewellery and designer handbags. <-- Text B [1 mark] **(1)**

(b) Using Text B, identify **two** benefits of the sharing economy to dog owners.

1 Their dogs can enjoy more walks and find a loving home instead of being sent to kennels. <-- Text B [1 mark] **(1)**

2 It saves dog owners money on expensive kennel fees. <-- Text B [1 mark] **(1)**

(Total for Question 8 = 4 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION B = 9 MARKS

SECTION B SUMMARY · TEXT B (QUESTIONS 5 TO 8) 9 / 9 MARKS

· Question 8(a) & 8(b) (4 Marks Total): Make sure you take evidence strictly from Text B (not Text A or Text C).

· Keep each point distinct so you do not repeat the same idea across lines 1 and 2.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

SECTION C

Read Text C and answer Questions 9 to 11.

9 Using Text C, give **two** quotations that suggest sports equipment can be hard to afford.

1 'expensive sports equipment' (or 'gear is particularly costly')

<-- Exact quote #1 from Text C [1 mark] (1)

2 'never have the funds' (or 'considerably less money will have been wasted') <-- Exact quote #2 from Text C [1 mark] (1)

(Total for Question 9 = 2 marks)

10 Using Text C, identify **two** language features used to advise the reader on renting.

Give an example to support each answer.

Language feature Rule of three

<-- Feature 1 [1 mark] (1)

Example 'saves me money, helps the planet and enables me to try new pursuits' <-- Exact quote from Text C [1 mark] (1)

Language feature Rhetorical question (or Command / Alliteration)

<-- Feature 2 [1 mark] (1)

Example 'Why store mountains of unwanted items?' (or 'Rent it, don't buy it' / 'storing stacks') <-- Exact quote from Text C [1 mark] (1)

(Total for Question 10 = 4 marks)

MFS EXAMINER STRATEGY · QUOTATIONS & LANGUAGE FEATURES (QUESTIONS 9 & 10)

· Question 9 (2 Marks): Copy exact words from Text C inside quotation marks that match the question focus.

· Question 10 (4 Marks): Name 2 distinct language features (1 mark each) + give an exact matching example from Text C (1 mark each).

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

Answer Question 11 with a cross in a box ☒. If you change your mind about an answer, put a line through the box ☒ and then mark your new answer with a cross ☒.

11 Which **one** of these quotations from Text C shows that the writer has a positive view of renting toys?

- ☐ **A** 'paying a small fee'
- ☐ **B** 'easy to access online services'
- ☒ **C** 'to try new pursuits' *[1 mark]*
- ☐ **D** 'exciting new playthings'

^ Correct: Option C: 'exciting new playthings' (p...

(Total for Question 11 = 1 mark)

TOTAL FOR SECTION C = 7 MARKS

SECTION C SUMMARY · TEXT C (QUESTIONS 9 TO 11) 7 / 7 MARKS

· Question 11 (1 Mark): Check whether the question asks for a POSITIVE or NEGATIVE view in Text C.

· Eliminate neutral statements or quotations that describe the opposite viewpoint.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

SECTION D

Questions 12 to 15 are based on more than one text.

12 You may use a dictionary to answer this question.

(a) 'precious space for permanent storage'

Give **one** word or phrase to replace 'precious' that keeps the meaning of this quotation from Text A the same.

valuable / important / treasured / limited [1 mark] **(1)**

(b) 'can prove prohibitive'

Give **one** word or phrase to replace 'prohibitive' that keeps the meaning of this quotation from Text C the same.

expensive / excessive / extortionate / unreasonable [1 mark] **(1)**

(Total for Question 12 = 2 marks)

13 Compare similar ideas from Text A **and** Text C about the advantages of renting.

In your answer you should:

- give **two** similarities from these texts about the advantages of renting **(2)**
- give **one** quotation from Text A and **one** quotation from Text C to support **each** similarity. **(4)**

Similarity 1: Both texts state that renting items is much cheaper [Sim 1: 1m]

and saves you money.

• Text A quote: 'The advantages of renting are costs that are much [Quote A: 1m]

lower' (or 'affordable access to items')

• Text C quote: 'I'm a renter rather than a buyer because renting saves me money' [Quote C: 1m]

Similarity 2: Both texts explain that renting saves storage space [Sim 2: 1m]

and is better for the environment.

• Text A quote: 'there is no need to give up precious space for [Quote A: 1m]

permanent storage.' (Paragraph 2)

• Text C quote: 'not storing stacks and stacks of stuff' [Quote C: 1m]

(Total for Question 13 = 6 marks)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

Answer Question 14 with a cross in a box ☒. If you change your mind about an answer, put a line through the box ☒ and then mark your new answer with a cross ☒.

14 Which **one** of these statements about the language used in Text A and Text B is correct?

- ☐ **A** Both use questions to help you decide.
- ☐ **B** Both use first person to offer opinions.
- ☒ **C** Both use rule of three to convey detail. *[1 mark]*
- ☐ **D** Both use numbers to provide evidence.

^ Correct: Option C: Both use rule of three to co...

(Total for Question 14 = 1 mark)

15 You are doing a project on renting.

Identify **one** piece of evidence from **each** of the three texts which shows that renting is popular with young people.

Text A ***Renting is 'very popular, particularly with the younger generation',***

<-- Relevant evidence from Text A *[1 mark]*

Text B ***'Teenagers and twenty-somethings are boosting the sharing economy'***

and prefer access over ownership. *<-- Relevant evidence from Text B* *[1 mark]*

Text C ***'Loads of 16 to 25-year-olds are discovering the benefits of***

renting', *<-- Relevant evidence from Text C* *[1 mark]*

(Total for Question 15 = 3 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION D = 12 MARKS
TOTAL FOR PAPER = 35 MARKS

FINAL PAPER SUMMARY · QUESTIONS 12 TO 15 (COMPARE & SYNTHESISE) · TOTAL: 35 / 35 (100%)

· Question 15 (3 Marks): Always give 1 distinct piece of evidence from EACH text (Text A = 1m, Text B = 1m, Text C = 1m).

· Full Paper Breakdown: Q1·4 (Text A) = 7/7 | Q5·8 (Text B) = 9/9 | Q9·11 (Text C) = 7/7 | Q12·15 (Multi-Text) = 12/12.

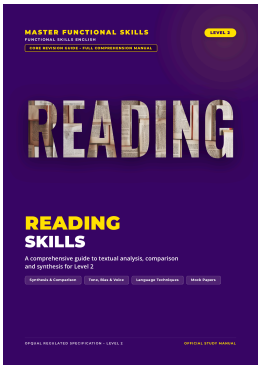
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS STORE

OFFICIAL REVISION GUIDES, WORKBOOKS & FLASHCARDS

Written by accredited specialist tutors to match the exact 2026 Pearson Edexcel standards

Everything You Need To Revise, Practice & Pass Your English Level 2 Reading Exam



Core Reading Manual

Reading Level 2
Core Study Guide

- Full official curriculum coverage
- Language & organisational features
- Bias, tone, fact/opinion & comparison
- Dyslexia-friendly visual format

Spiral Bound Print & PDF

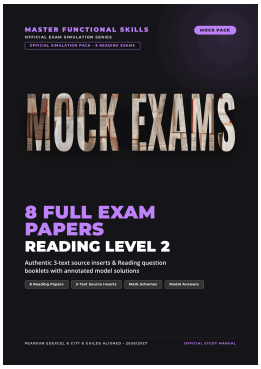


30+ Source Text Drills

Reading Level 2
Companion Workbook

- 30+ authentic non-fiction extracts
- Progressive retrieval & inference drills
- Multi-text comparison & synthesis grids
- Full worked step-by-step answer key

Spiral Bound Print & PDF

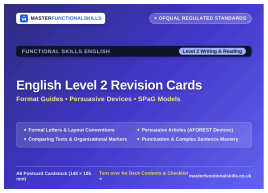


Realistic Mock Papers

Reading Level 2
Official Mock Exam Book

- 8 full Reading mock exam paper sets
- Authentic 3-text source inserts
- Detailed mark schemes included
- Grade boundaries & pass marks

Exam Booklet Pack & PDF



Pocket Flashcards A6

English Level 2
Reading & English Cards

- Compact A6 cards for quick study
- Language devices & layout features
- Dual-sided question & answer drills
- High-yield reading comparison rules

Boxed Card Deck & Print PDF

Order Official Study Guides & Revision Cards Online

Free Next-Day UK Tracked Shipping · Instant PDF Downloads Included

Trusted by training providers, apprentices & adult learners nationwide.

VISIT THE ONLINE STORE

MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk